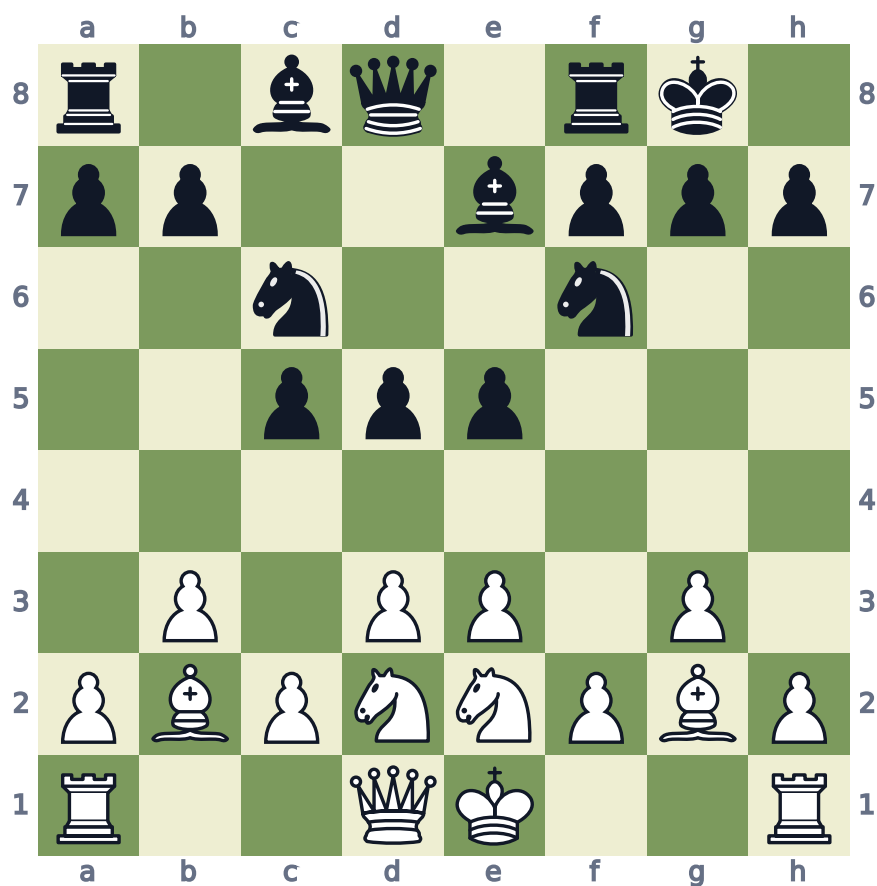


White Hippo Foundations and Repertoire Map

The 1.g3 shell, response map, break compass, and practical limits



Build a White Hippopotamus from understanding and use the extra tempo to choose the correct central claim before flexibility becomes passivity.

12 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Build a White Hippopotamus from understanding and use the extra tempo to choose the correct central claim before flexibility becomes passivity.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 12 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The White Hippo is a flexible system, not eight automatic setup moves.

PRINCIPLE 2

The usual shell uses g3, Bg2, d3, e3, Nd2, Ne2, b3, and Bb2 in an order set by Black's center.

PRINCIPLE 3

White's useful transformations are usually e4, d4, c4, or f4.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

The first move gives White an extra tempo, but only a purposeful break preserves it.

PRINCIPLE 5

The long diagonals must be checked before b3 or Bb2 is played.

PRINCIPLE 6

Leave the shell immediately when a direct central move solves the position better.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Classical d5-e5 center map | The full center sets a deadline: prepare contact before adding decorative moves. |
| 02 | Single e5 center map | A single e-pawn becomes a full center quickly; choose the break early. |
| 03 | c5 structure map | Against a g7 bishop, c3 makes b3 safe. |
| 04 | King's Indian setup map | In mirrored fianchettos, the first purposeful break owns the extra tempo. |
| 05 | Dutch setup map | The Dutch pawn gives White e4; make that square useful. |
| 06 | French structure map | Attack the French chain before it fixes itself. |
| 07 | Caro structure map | The Caro shell is comfortable; contact it before completion. |
| 08 | Owen setup map | Bb7 is safe only after d5 blocks Bxb7. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 9-12

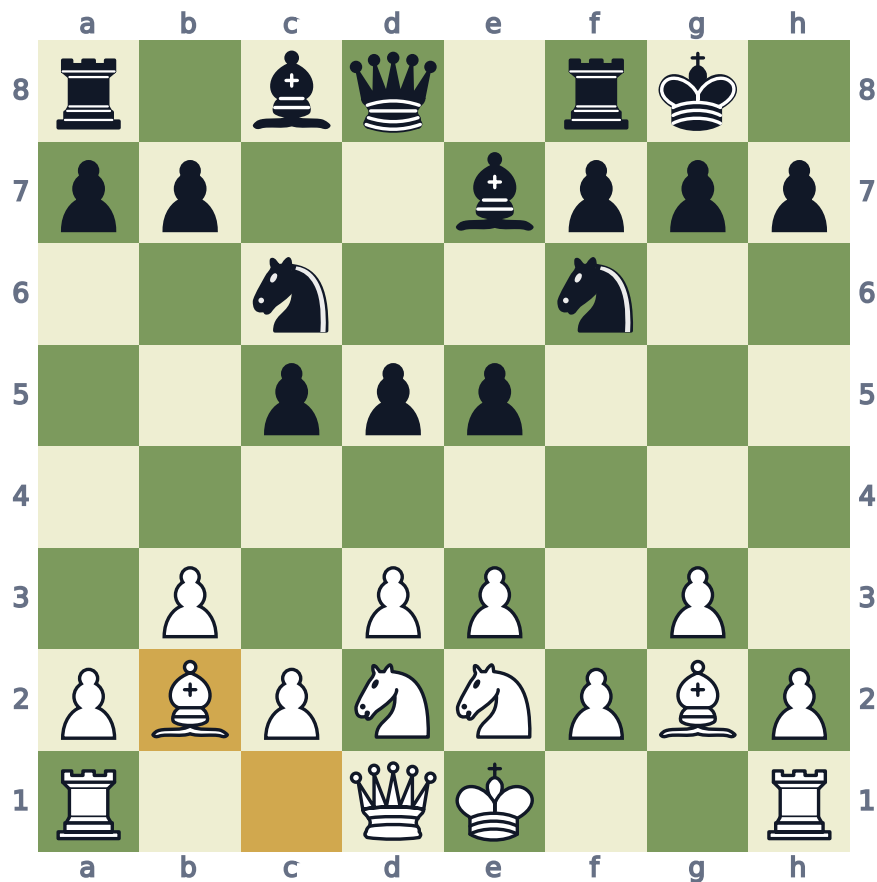
- | | | |
|-----------|-------------------------|---|
| 09 | e4 break compass | e4 is the main break when d5 is the weaker base. |
| | | |
| 10 | c4 break compass | c4 is useful when the g2 bishop and c-pawn cooperate against d5. |
| | | |
| 11 | f4 break compass | f4 is a lever, not a shelter; use it before Black establishes d5. |
| | | |
| 12 | d4 break compass | d4 is strongest when it activates pieces behind the pawn. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Classical d5-e5 center map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. b3 Nc6 8. Bb2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Complete the shell only far enough to prepare e4 or c4 against the broad center.

MAIN DANGER

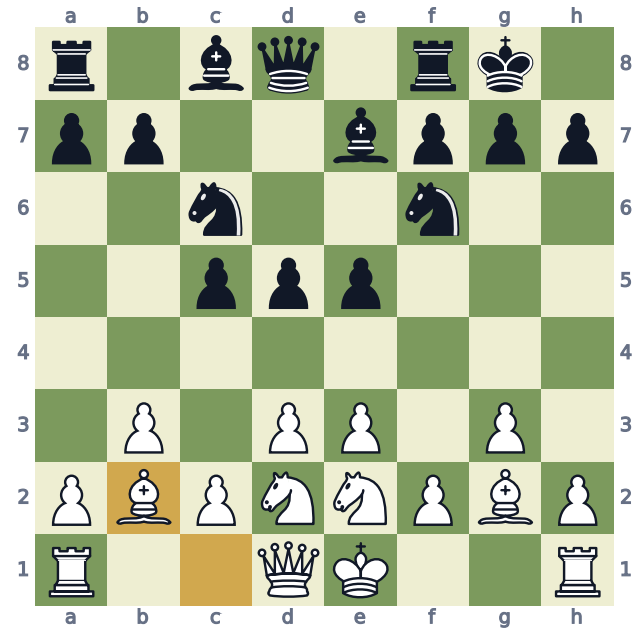
Black may advance d4 or e4 and take more space.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The full center sets a deadline: prepare contact before adding decorative moves.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.70 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be6 O-O 2. Re8 h3 3. d4 Nc4 4. b5 Bxc6 5. bxc4 exd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Classical d5-e5 center map



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Single e5 center map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Bd6 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

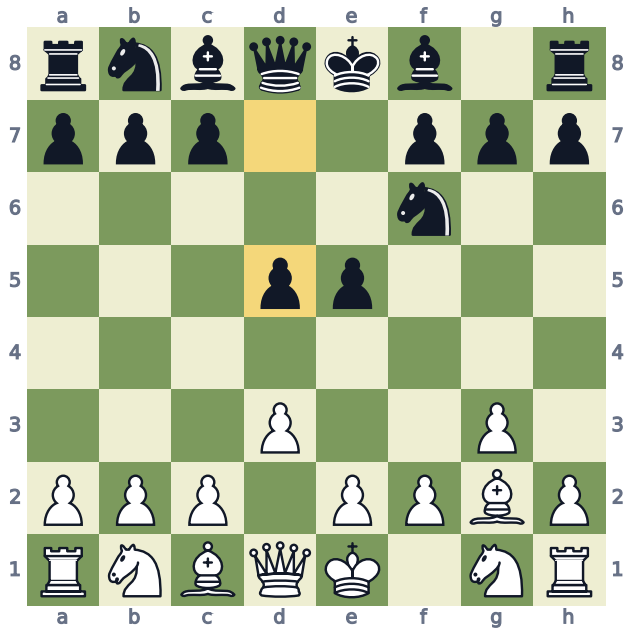
Prepare e4, c4, or d4 while developing safely.

MAIN DANGER

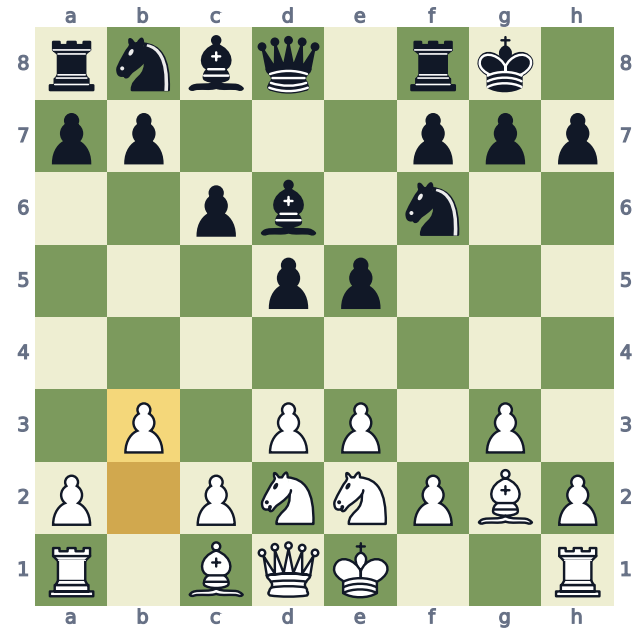
Black can gain time with e4 if White remains uncommitted.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A single e-pawn becomes a full center quickly; choose the break early.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

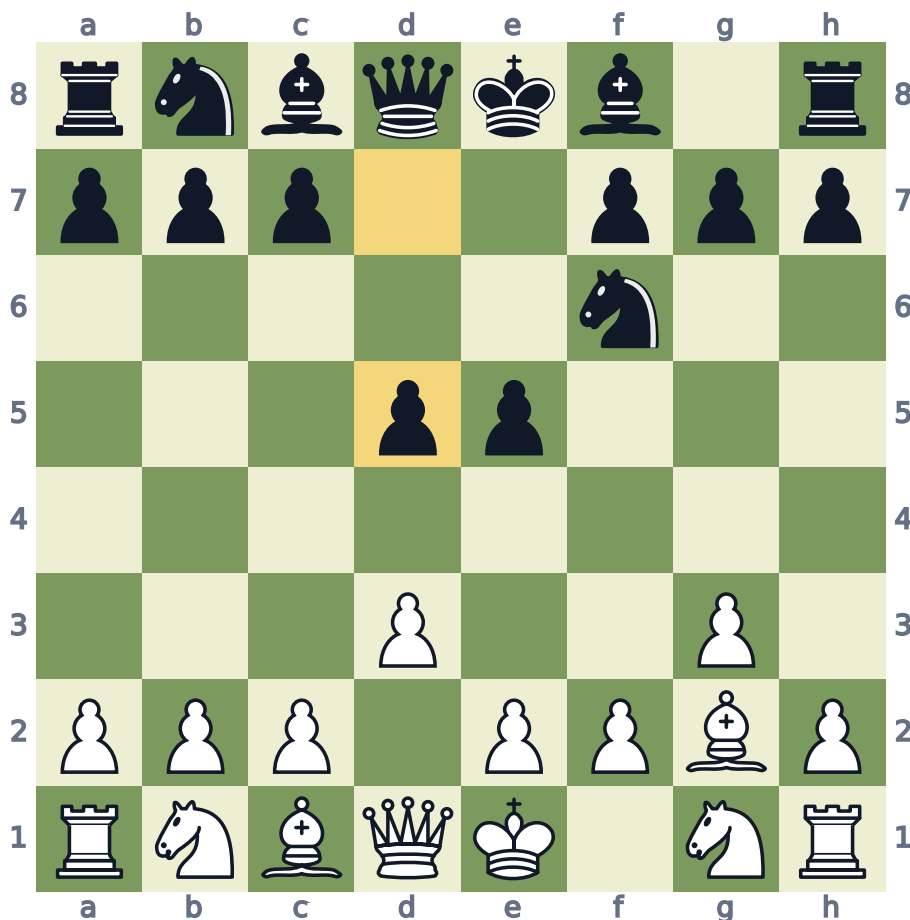
Position estimate: -0.73 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 O-O 2. Re8 c4 3. Na6 Bb2 4. Nc5 cxd5 5. cxd5 Nf3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Single e5 center map



YOUR TASK

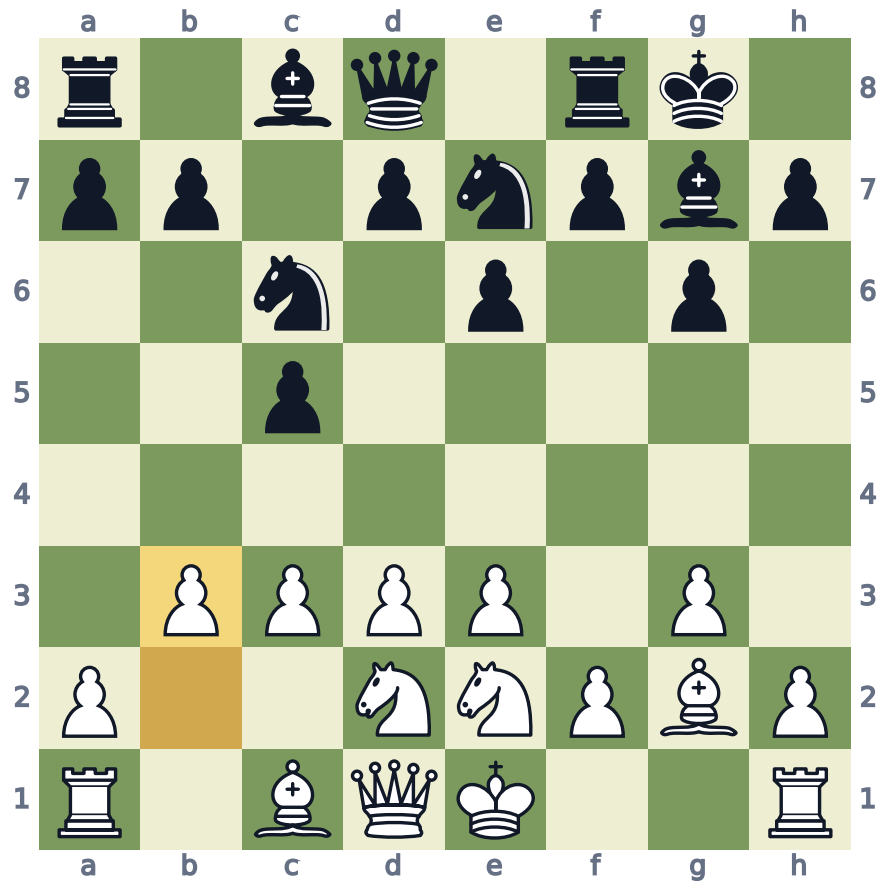
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

c5 structure map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Nge7 7. c3 O-O 8. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

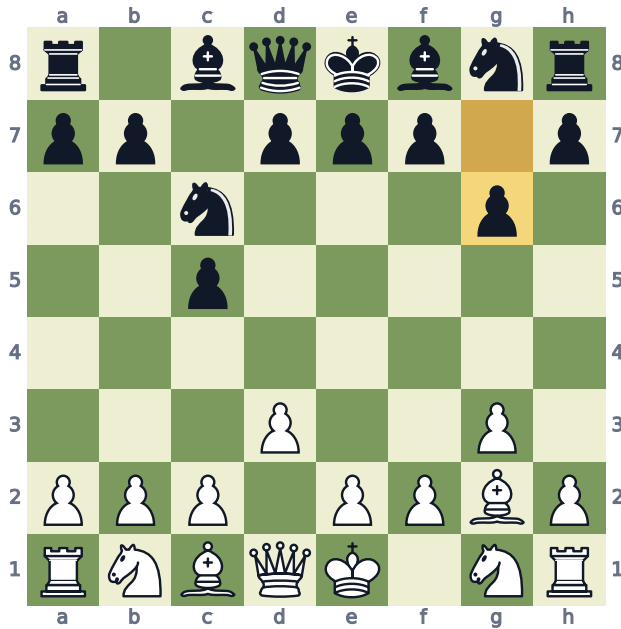
Use c3 to secure the a1 diagonal and prepare d4 or e4.

MAIN DANGER

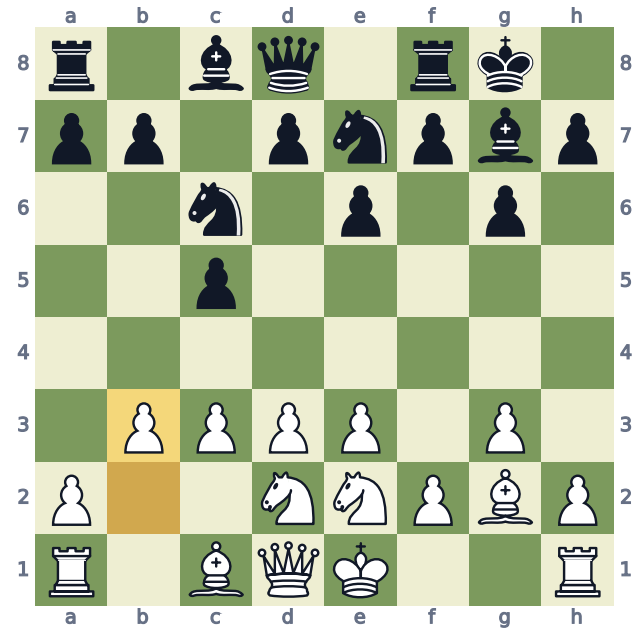
Black's d5 break can equalize before White claims the center.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against a g7 bishop, c3 makes b3 safe.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

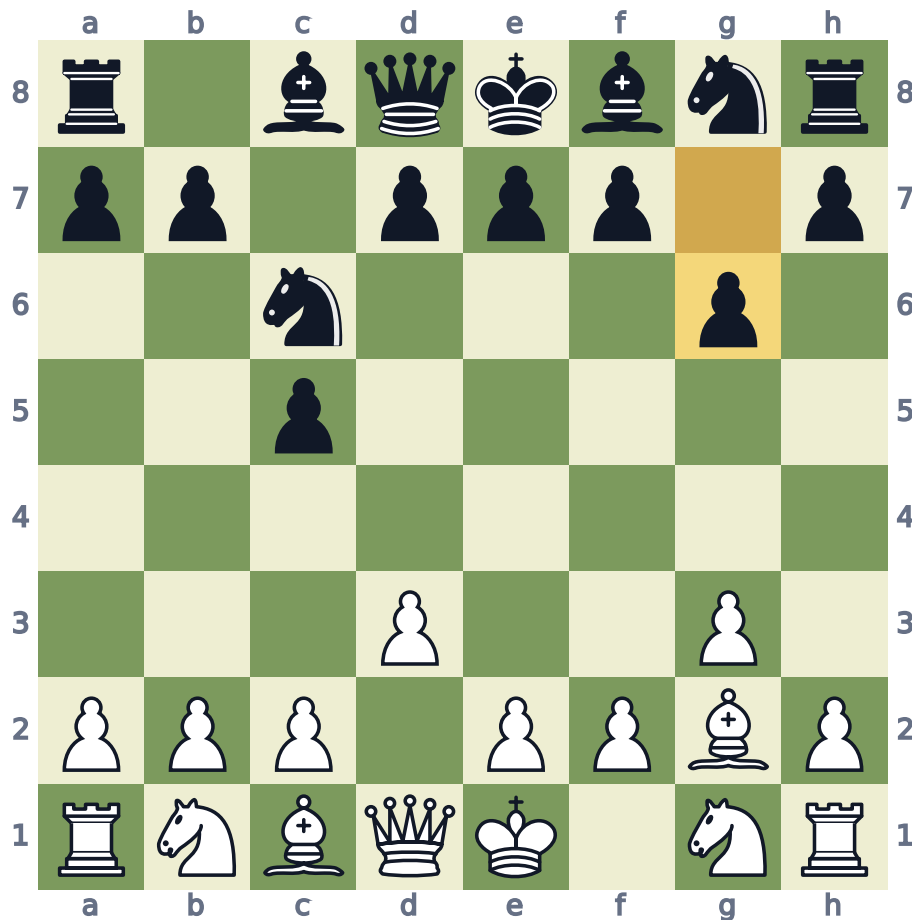
Position estimate: -0.46 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 O-O 2. b5 Bb2 3. Qb6 Qc2 4. Rd8 a3 5. e5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

c5 structure map



YOUR TASK

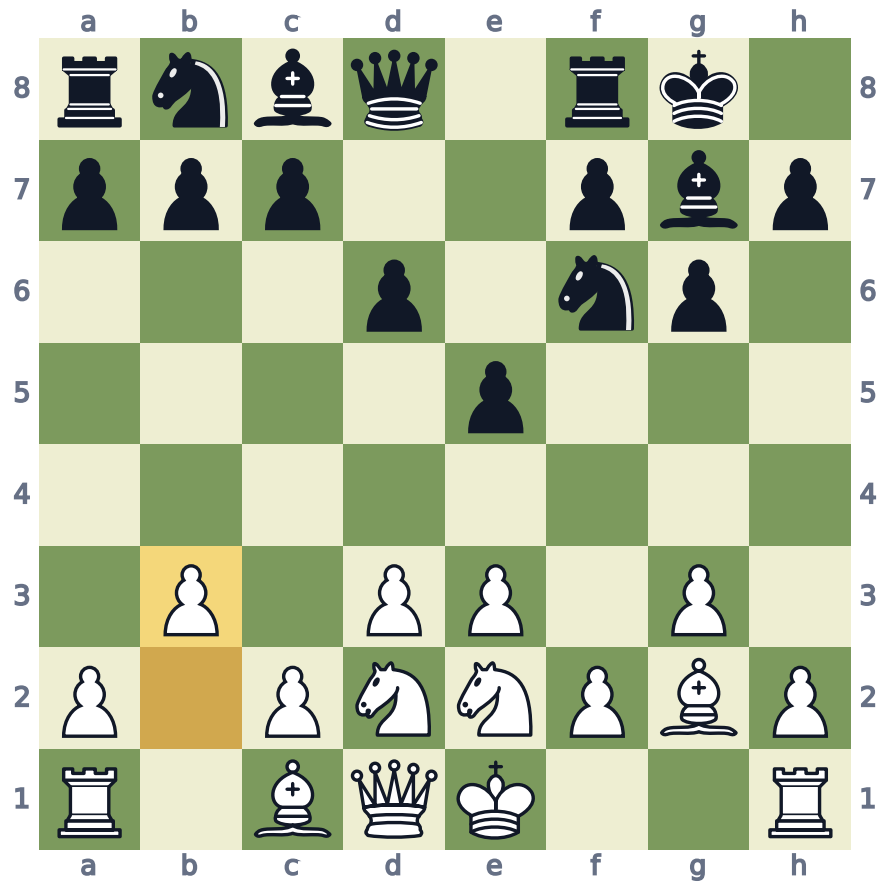
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

King's Indian setup map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

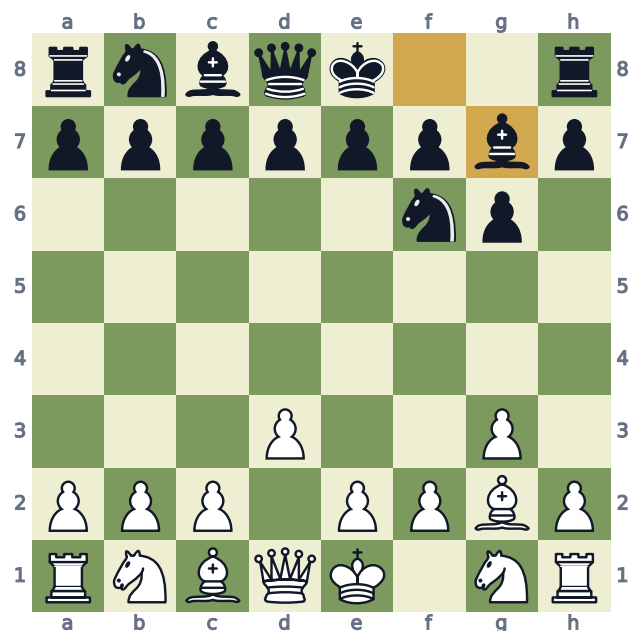
Use the extra tempo to choose e4, c4, or d4 before Black begins f5.

MAIN DANGER

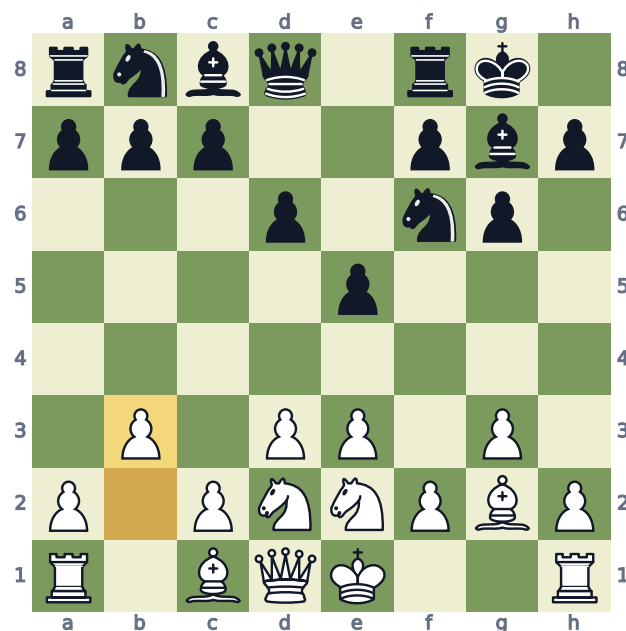
Empty symmetry can surrender the initiative.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

In mirrored fianchettoes, the first purposeful break owns the extra tempo.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

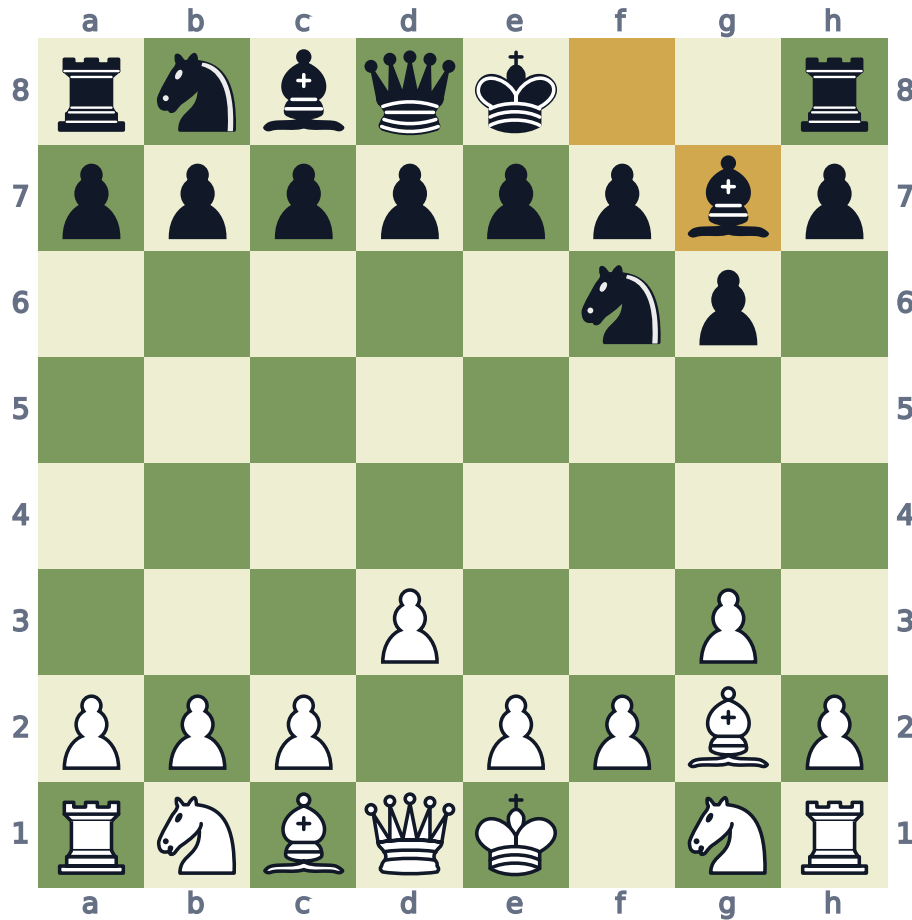
Position estimate: -0.38 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 O-O 2. c5 c4 3. Nc6 a3 4. Bg4 h3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

King's Indian setup map



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Dutch setup map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 f5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 g6 4. Nd2 Bg7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 d6 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

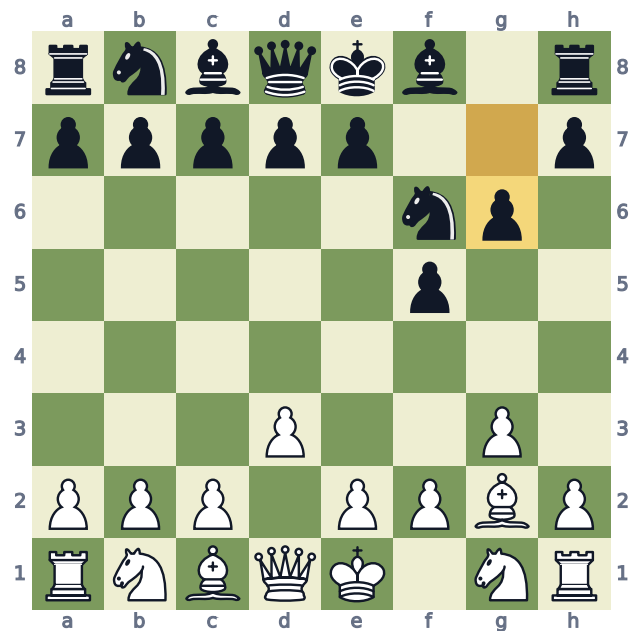
Control e4 and prepare central occupation against Black's f-pawn commitment.

MAIN DANGER

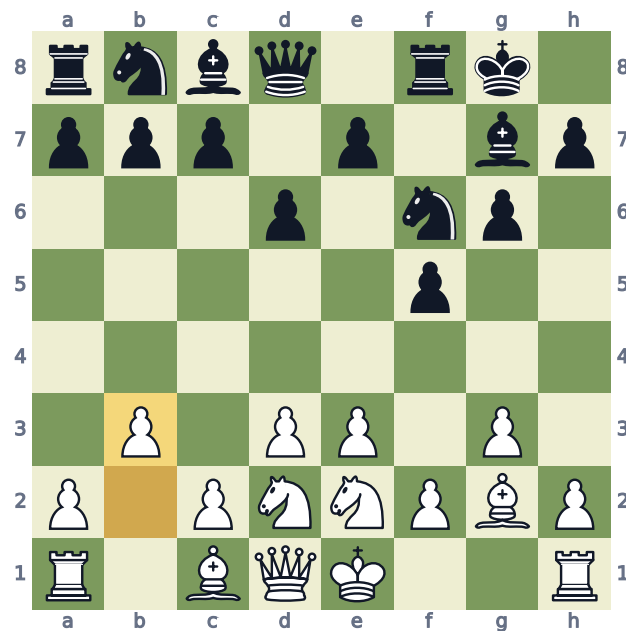
e5 and a kingside attack can arrive quickly.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The Dutch pawn gives White e4; make that square useful.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

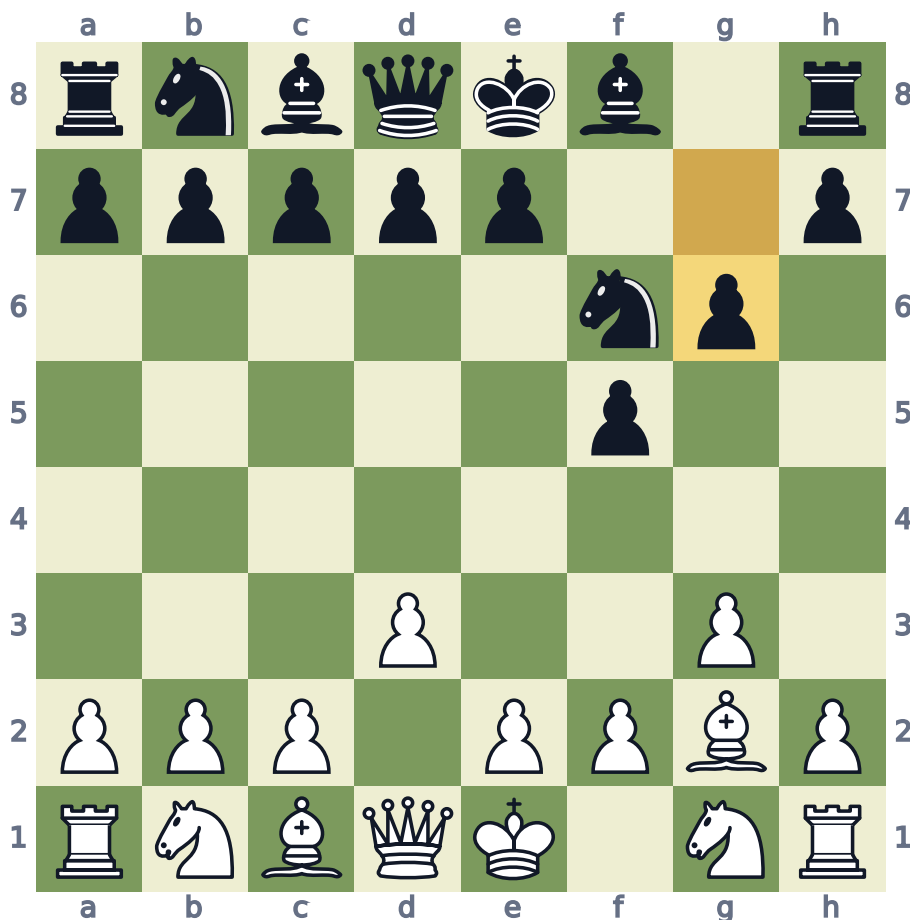
Position estimate: +0.16 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. a5 c4 2. e5 a3 3. c6 O-O 4. Be6 Bb2 5. Nbd7 Qc2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Dutch setup map



YOUR TASK

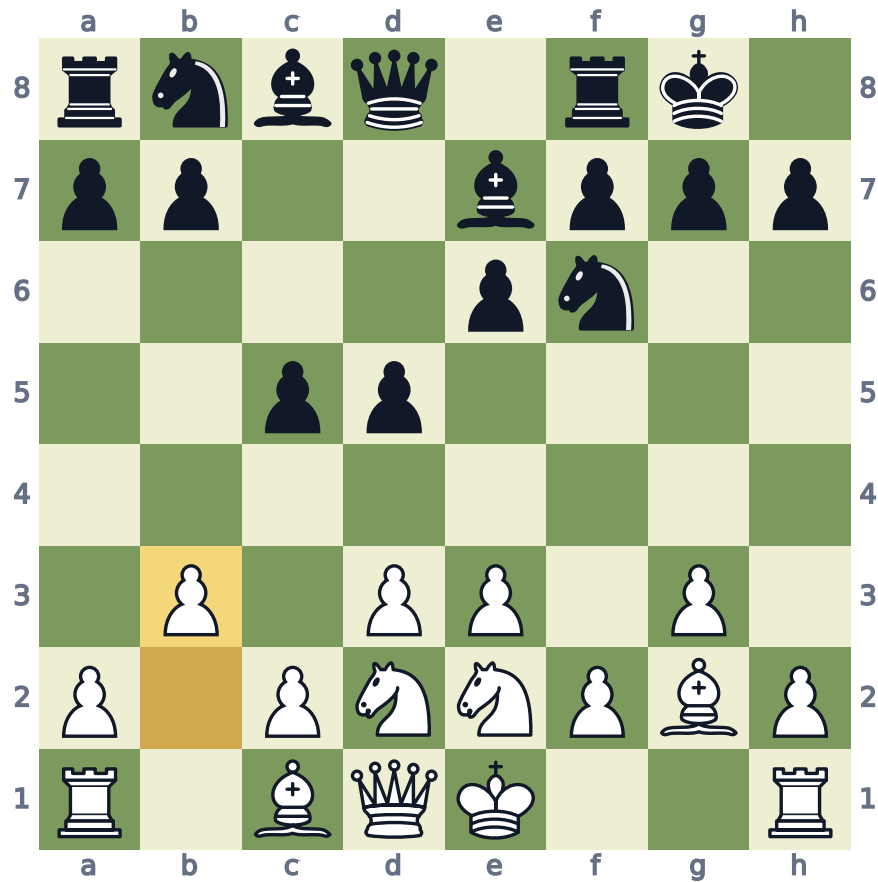
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

French structure map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Prepare e4 or c4 before Black's center becomes effortless.

MAIN DANGER

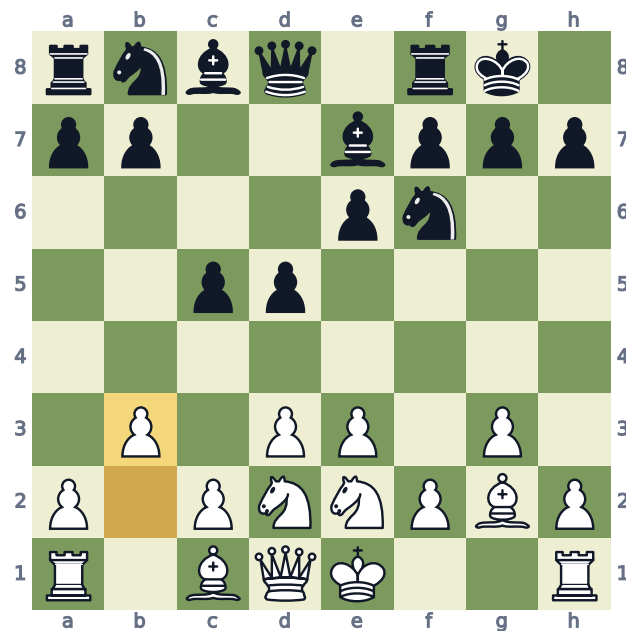
Black may advance d4 and cramp both knights.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Attack the French chain before it fixes itself.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.38 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 Bb2 2. Bd6 e4 3. d4 O-O 4. Nc6 a4 5. a6 Bc1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

French structure map



YOUR TASK

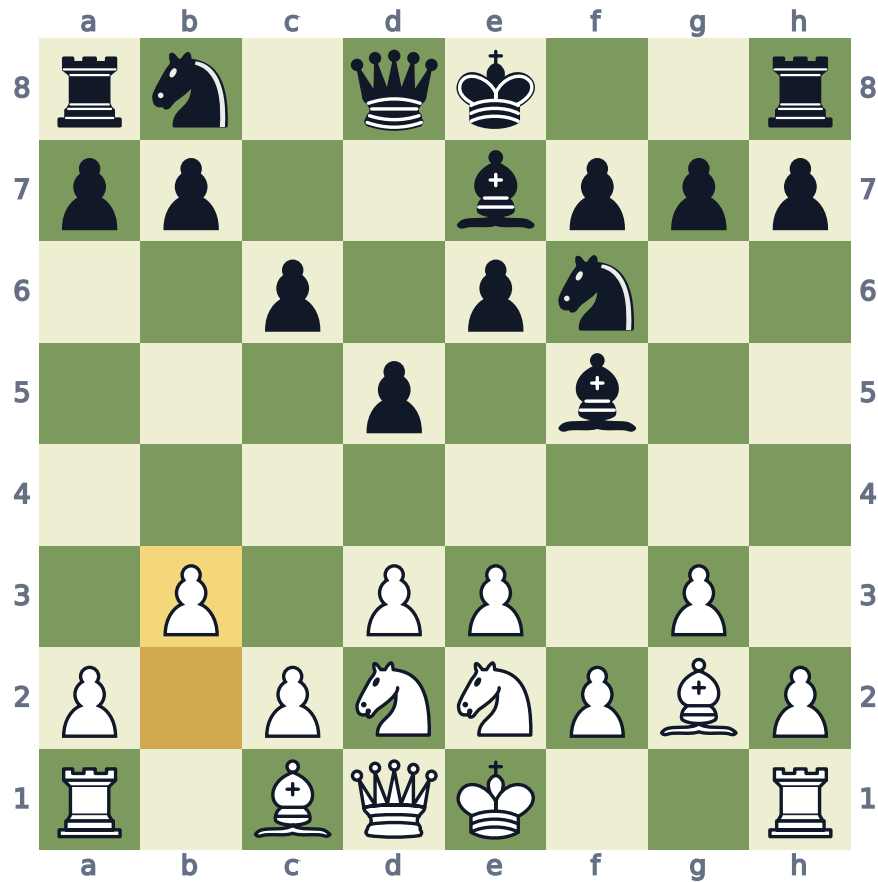
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Caro structure map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c6 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Bf5 4. Nd2 e6 5. e3 Nf6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

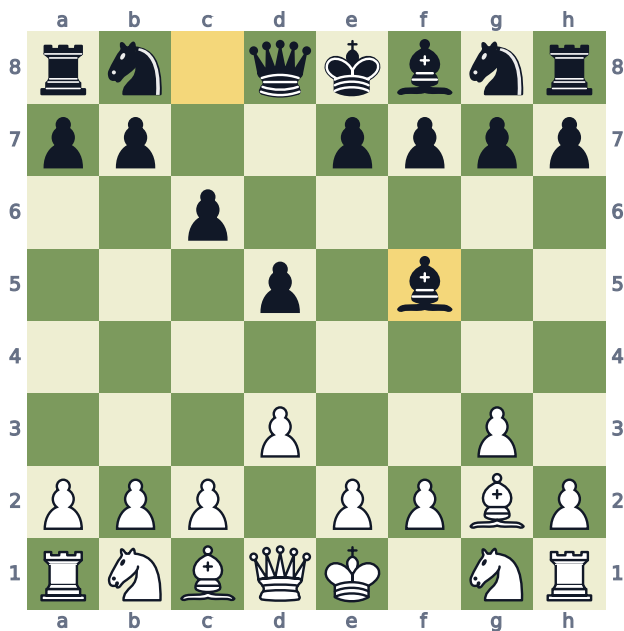
Prepare e4 while noting that Black's light bishop is already active.

MAIN DANGER

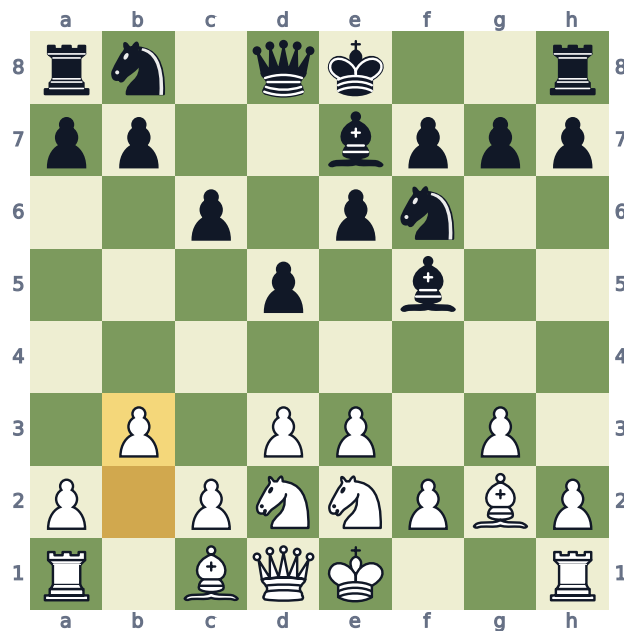
Black can play e5 if White waits.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The Caro shell is comfortable; contact it before completion.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

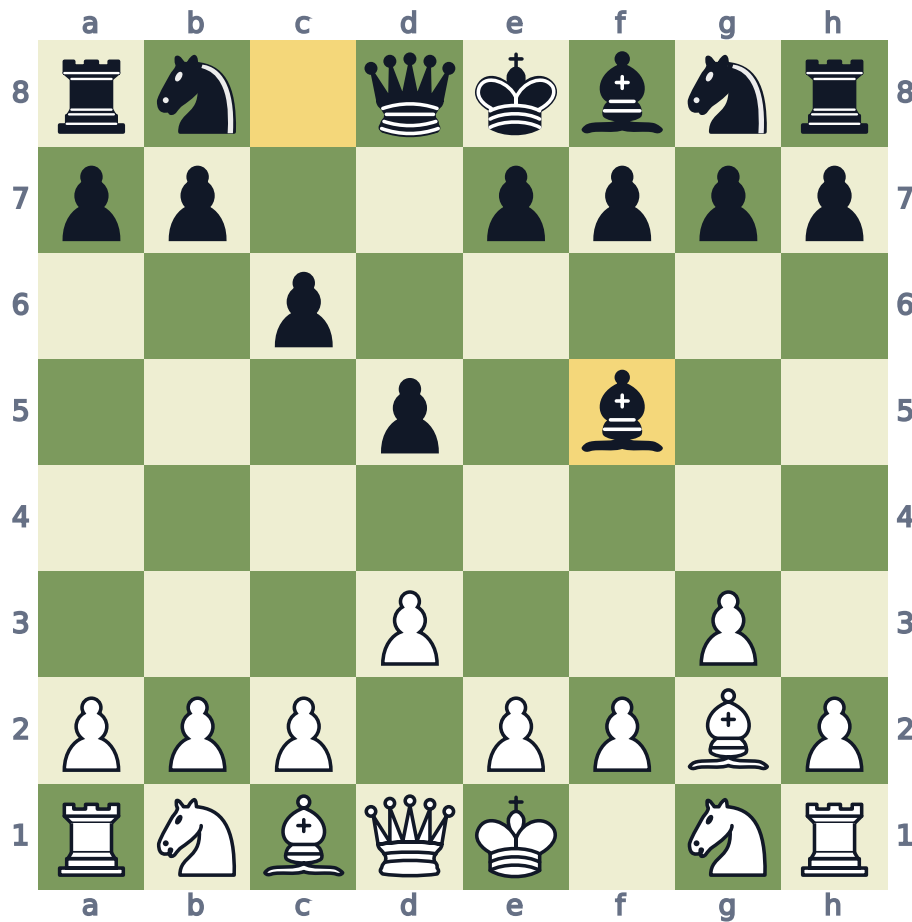
Position estimate: -0.24 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h6 e4 2. Bh7 Bb2 3. O-O O-O 4. a5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Caro structure map



YOUR TASK

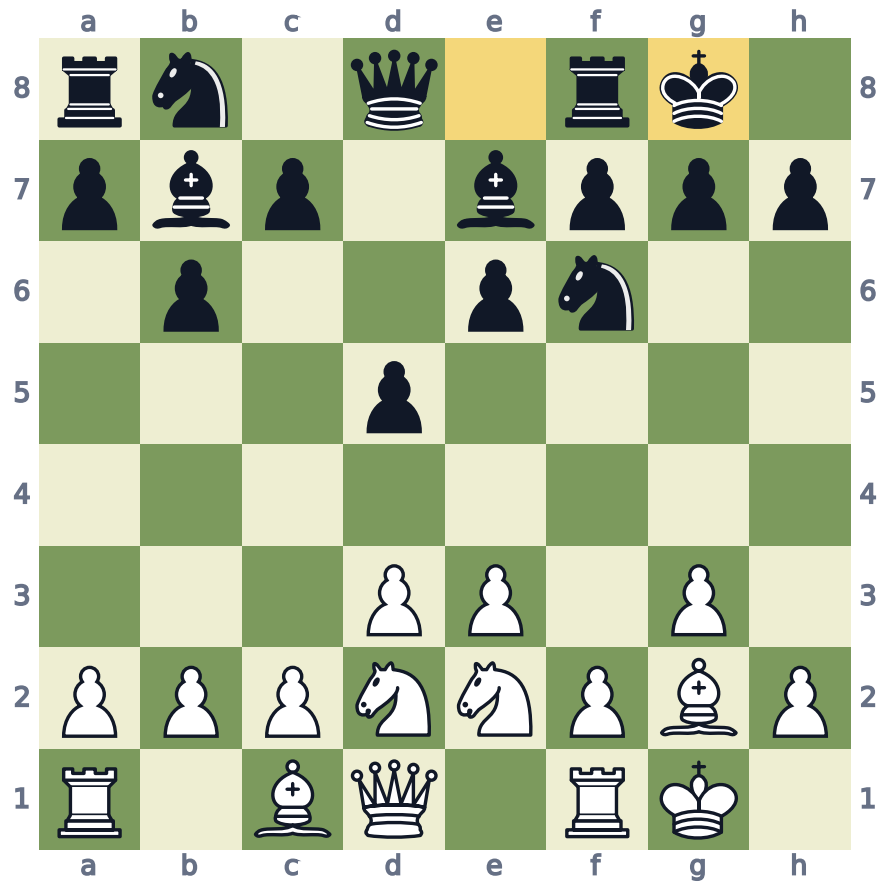
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Owen setup map



COURSE LINE

1. g3 b6 2. Bg2 Bb7 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e3 e6 6. Ne2 Be7 7. O-O O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

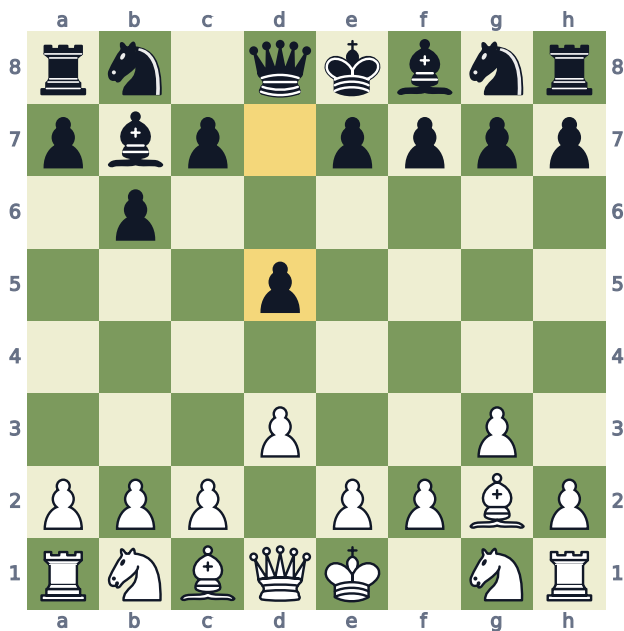
Use Black's d5 commitment to make the long diagonal safe, then prepare e4 or c4.

MAIN DANGER

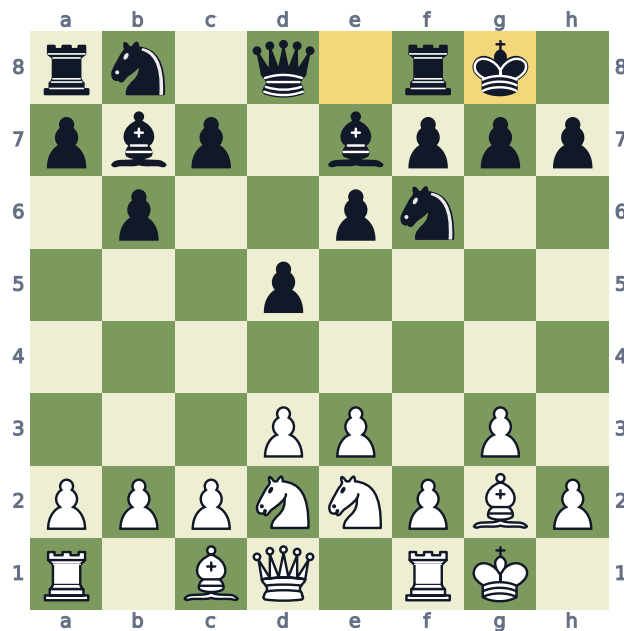
c5 can challenge the center before White acts.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Bb7 is safe only after d5 blocks Bxb7.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

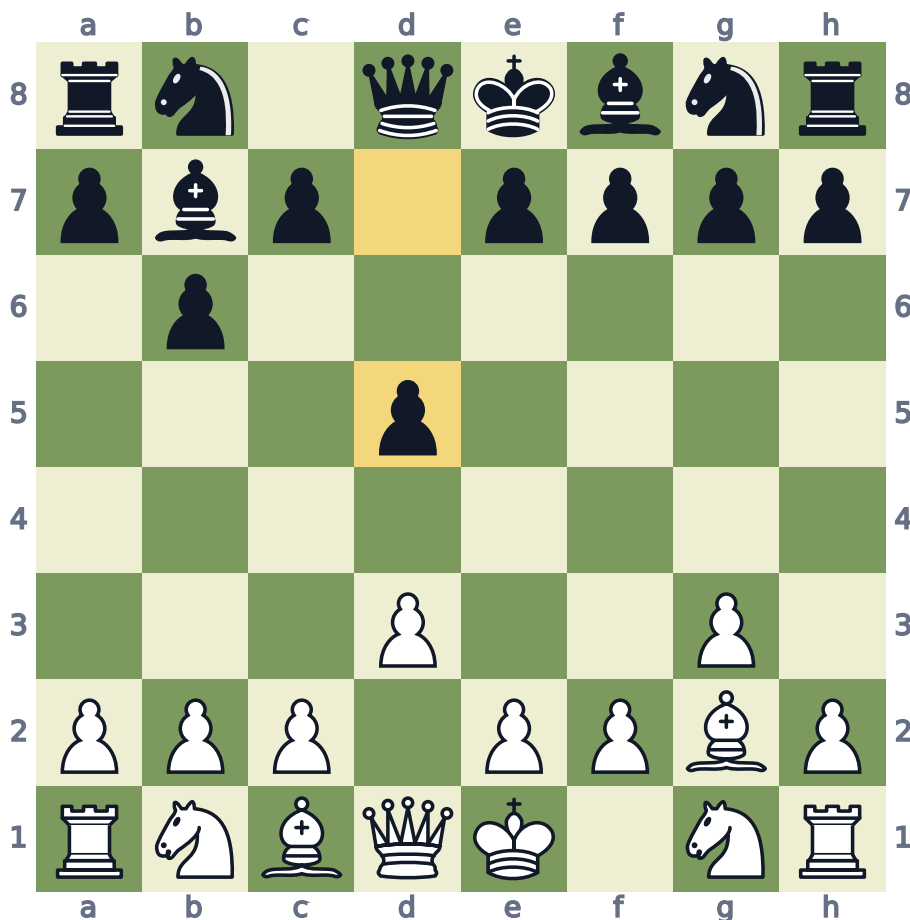
Position estimate: -0.34 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a3 c5 2. b3 Nc6 3. Bb2 Qd7 4. d4 h6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Owen setup map



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 09

e4 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge d5 and open central lines for the compact pieces.

MAIN DANGER

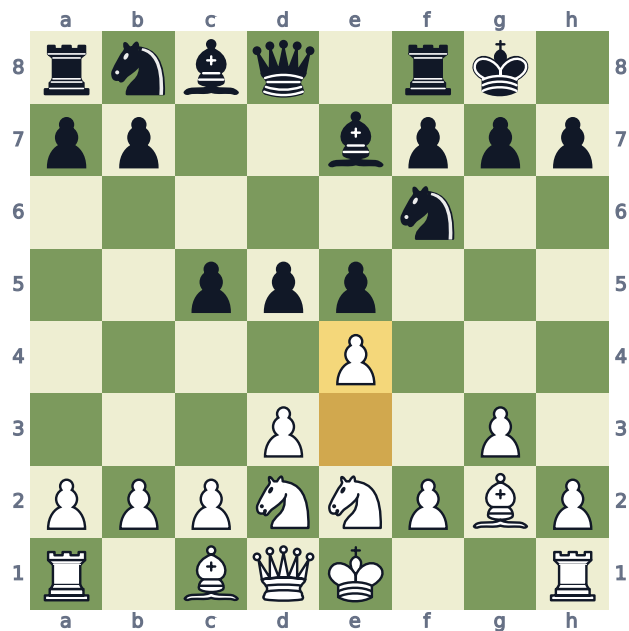
d4 can close space and give Black a protected chain.

BRANCH LOGIC 09

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

e4 is the main break when d5 is the weaker base.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.84 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O 2. Be6 b3 3. Qd7 Bb2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 09

e4 break compass



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 10

c4 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. c4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Attack d5 from the flank and create queenside play.

MAIN DANGER

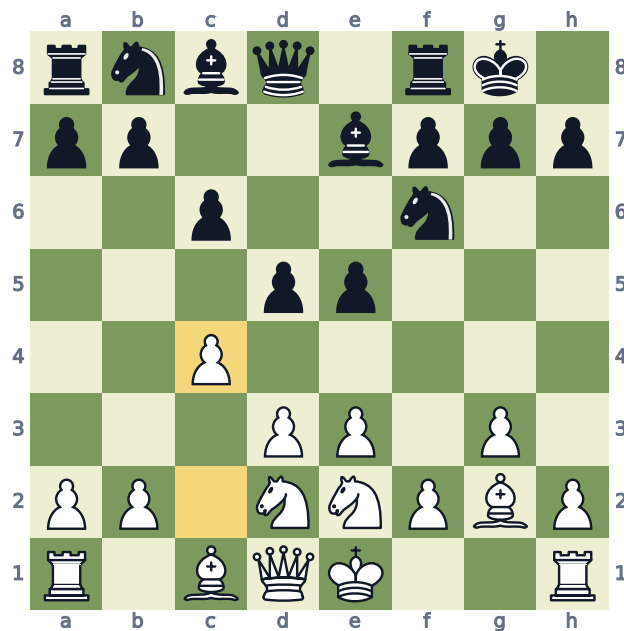
d4 can gain space and restrict White's knights.

BRANCH LOGIC 10

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

c4 is useful when the g2 bishop and c-pawn cooperate against d5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.05 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bf5 e4 2. dxe4 dxe4 3. Be6 O-O 4. Na6 a3 5. Nc5 Qc2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 10

c4 break compass



YOUR TASK

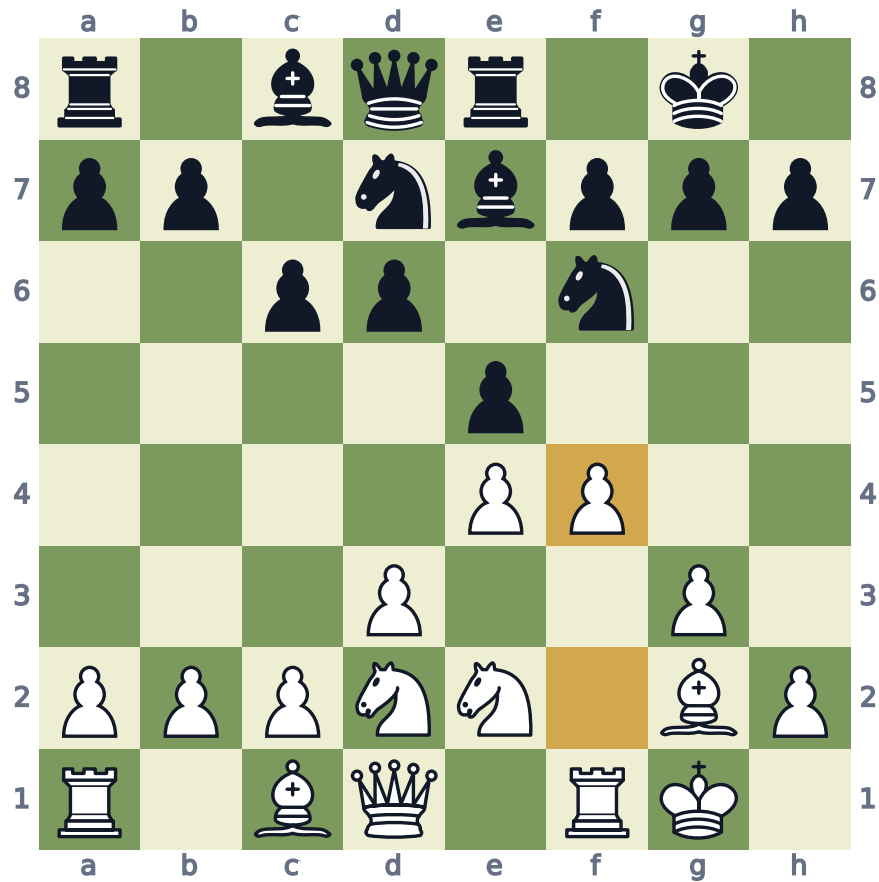
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 11

f4 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 d6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. O-O Re8 8. e4 Nbd7 9. f4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

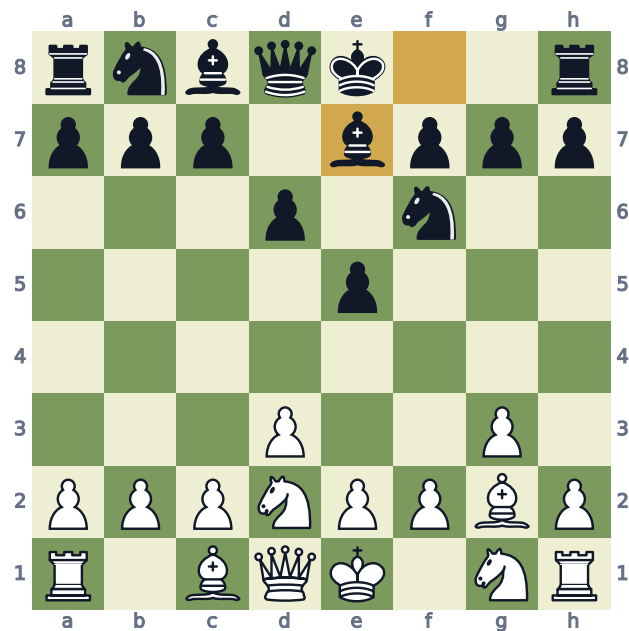
Build e4-f4 after castling against Black's compact e5-d6 center.

MAIN DANGER

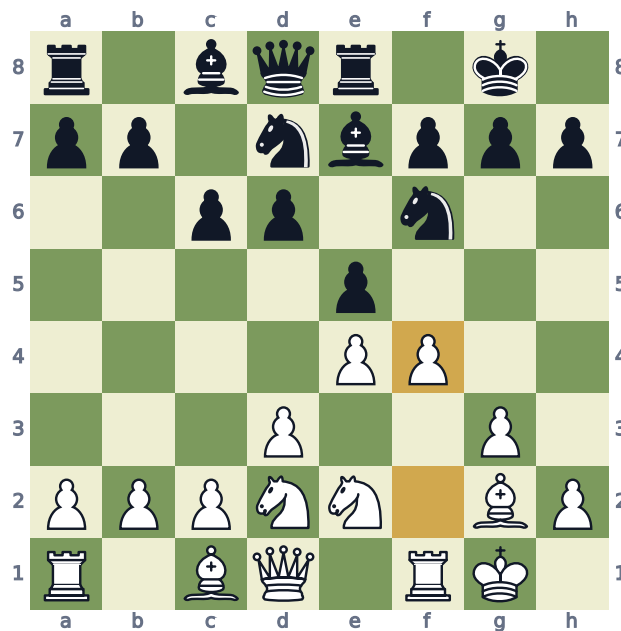
exf4 can open lines against White's king.

BRANCH LOGIC 11

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

f4 is a lever, not a shelter; use it before Black establishes d5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

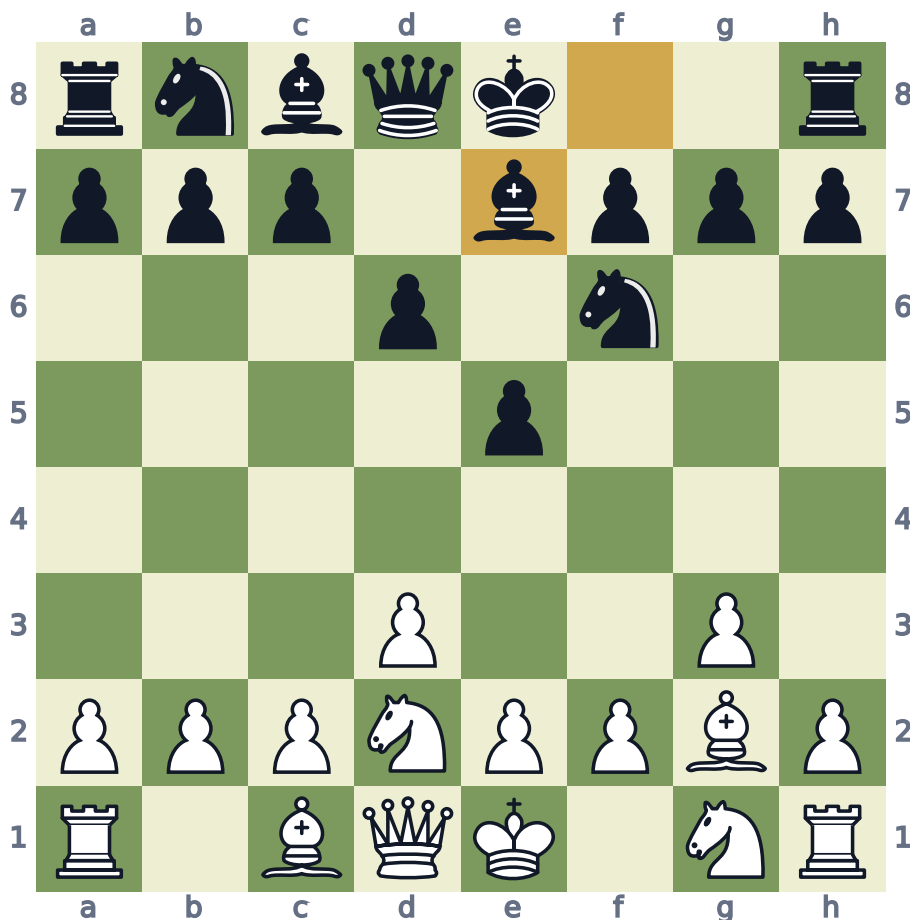
Position estimate: -0.56 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 Nc3 2. dxe4 Ndx4 3. exf4 Bxf4 4. Nxe4 Nxe4 5. Nf6 Kh1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 11

f4 break compass



YOUR TASK

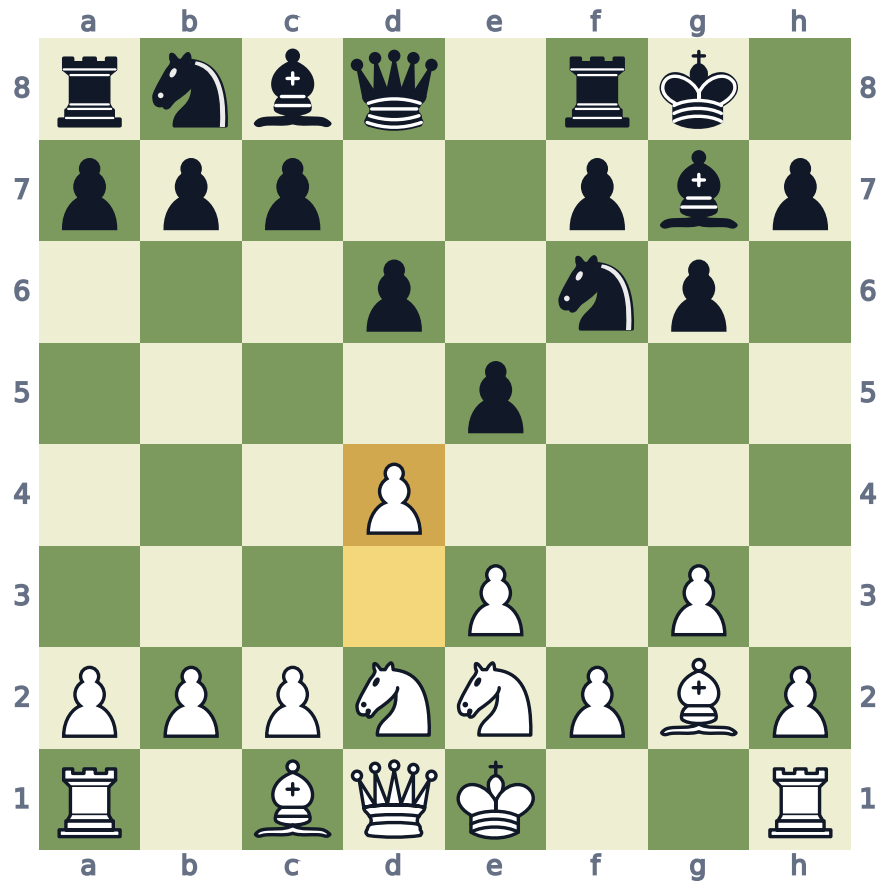
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 12

d4 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. d4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

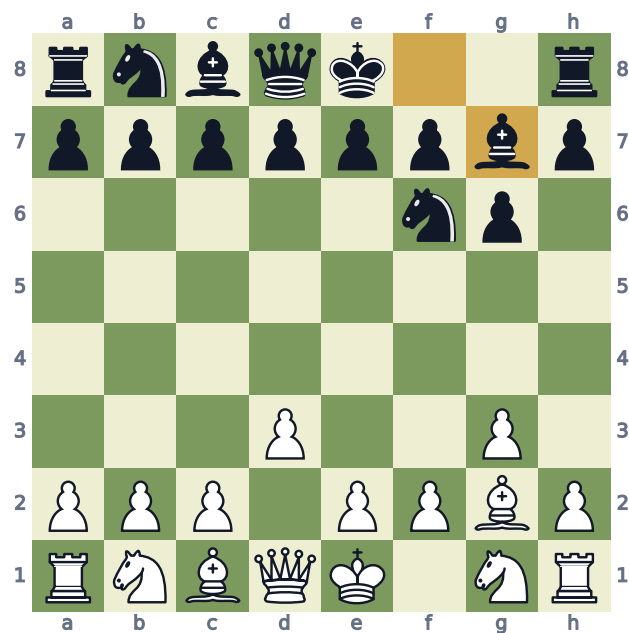
Claim the center and force Black to define the e4 tension.

MAIN DANGER

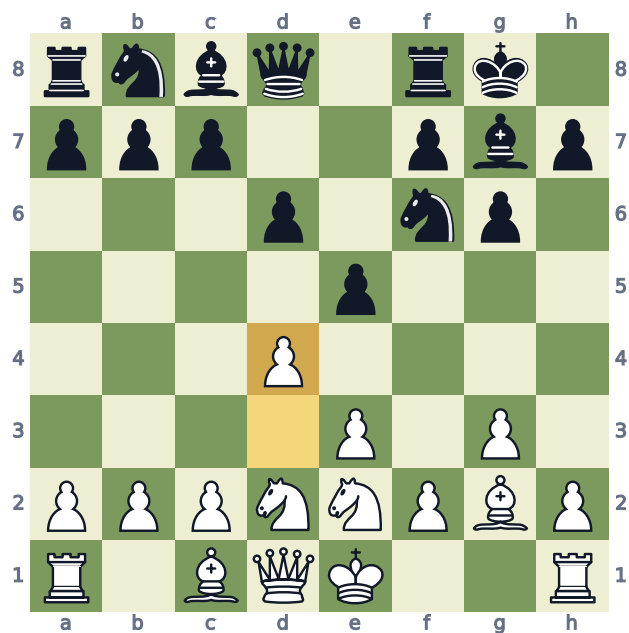
e4 can close the center and restrict White's pieces.

BRANCH LOGIC 12

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

d4 is strongest when it activates pieces behind the pawn.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

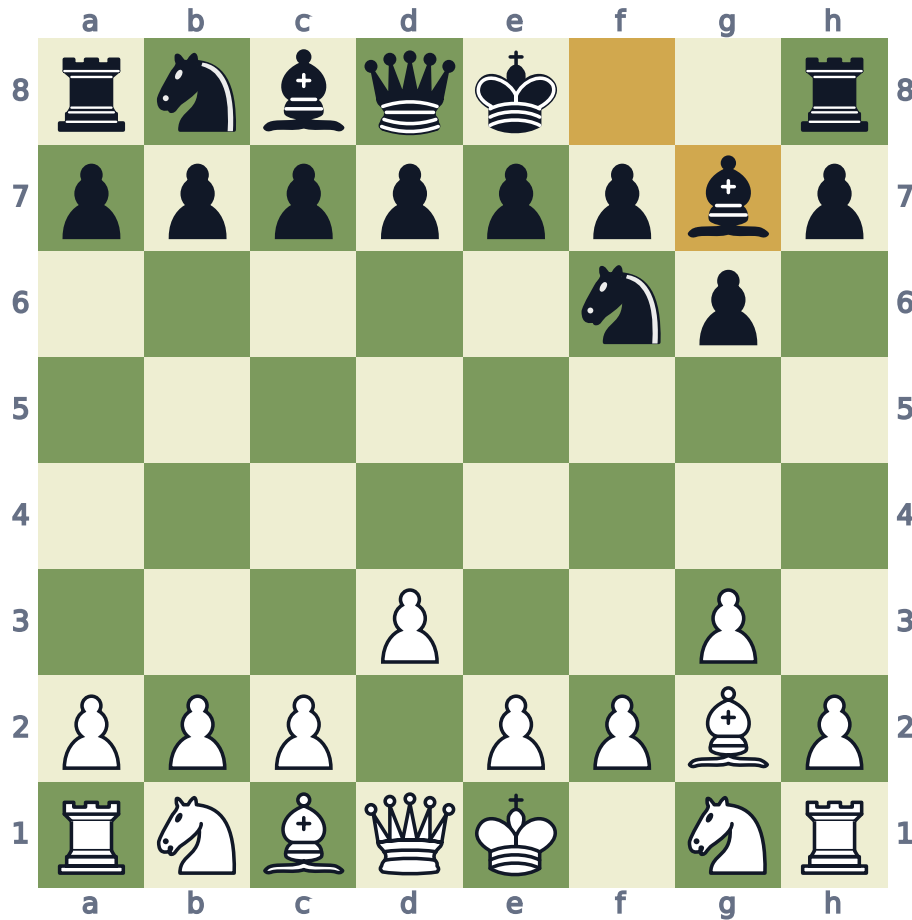
Position estimate: -0.61 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 b3 2. a4 O-O 3. exd4 exd4 4. Re8 Re1 5. axb3 cxb3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 12

d4 break compass



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. CLASSICAL D5-E5 CENTER MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Complete the shell only far enough to prepare e4 or c4 against the broad center. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: Black may advance d4 or e4 and take more space.

02. SINGLE E5 CENTER MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare e4, c4, or d4 while developing safely. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. O-O O-O 3. c4 c6 4. cxd5 cxd5 5. Bg5 Be6 (-0.23 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: Black can gain time with e4 if White remains uncommitted.

03. C5 STRUCTURE MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use c3 to secure the a1 diagonal and prepare d4 or e4. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Nf6 2. e4 Bg7 3. Nge2 d6 4. O-O Rb8 5. Nd5 O-O (+0.04 for White (equal)). Warning: Black's d5 break can equalize before White claims the center.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. KING'S INDIAN SETUP MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use the extra tempo to choose e4, c4, or d4 before Black begins f5. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: Empty symmetry can surrender the initiative.

05. DUTCH SETUP MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Control e4 and prepare central occupation against Black's f-pawn commitment. Engine comparison: 1. e4 fxe4 2. dxe4 d6 3. Nc3 e5 4. f4 Nc6 (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e5 and a kingside attack can arrive quickly.

06. FRENCH STRUCTURE MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare e4 or c4 before Black's center becomes effortless. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O a5 3. c4 O-O 4. Bf4 h6 5. Re1 (+0.01 for White (equal)). Warning: Black may advance d4 and cramp both knights.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-9

07. CARO STRUCTURE MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare e4 while noting that Black's light bishop is already active. Engine comparison: 1. Nd2 e5 2. Ngf3 Nd7 3. e4 dxe4 4. dxe4 Be6 5. Qe2 Bc5 (+0.45 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black can play e5 if White waits.

08. OWEN SETUP MAP

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use Black's d5 commitment to make the long diagonal safe, then prepare e4 or c4. Engine comparison: 1. c4 Nf6 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. d4 e6 4. e4 Nf6 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: c5 can challenge the center before White acts.

09. E4 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Challenge d5 and open central lines for the compact pieces. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close space and give Black a protected chain.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 10-12

10. C4 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Attack d5 from the flank and create queenside play. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can gain space and restrict White's knights.

11. F4 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: e3. Purpose: Build e4-f4 after castling against Black's compact e5-d6 center. Engine comparison: 1. Ngf3 c5 2. O-O Nc6 3. Nc4 h6 4. b3 Be6 5. a4 O-O (+0.13 for White (equal)). Warning: exf4 can open lines against White's king.

12. D4 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Claim the center and force Black to define the e5 tension. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: e4 can close the center and restrict White's pieces.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.